
Sharing Into Equal Groups — How Many Groups? How Many in Each?

Every division story has three numbers: the **total**, the number of **groups**, and how many are **in each group**. You are given two of them and you find the third.

- Read the question twice. Is it asking *how many groups* or *how many in each group*?
- Never write back a number the story already gave you — that is the number you were told, not the one you were asked for.
- Check every answer by multiplying: groups $\times$ in each group should give the total.

1. Ken has 18 stickers. He puts them into 3 bags with the same number in every bag. How many stickers are **in each bag**?

Answer: _____

2. Mia has 20 stickers. She puts 5 stickers in each bag. How many **bags** does she fill?

Answer: _____

3. Find and fix. There are 24 crackers. A plate gets 4 crackers. Ravi says, “There are 4 plates.”

Ravi wrote back a number the story already told him. Which one was it? Then write how many **plates** there really are.

Answer: _____

4. Find and fix. Leo plants 35 seeds in 5 pots. The same number of seeds goes in each pot. Leo says, “There are 5 seeds in each pot.”

Leo used the number of pots for the wrong job. Write how many **seeds are in each pot**.

Answer: _____

5. Ana has 48 apples. She puts 8 apples in each basket. She starts by writing this:

$$\underline{\hspace{1cm}} \times 8 = 48$$

Fill in the missing number. That number tells how many **baskets** Ana fills.

Answer: _____

6. Find and fix. A teacher has 40 markers. She gives 8 markers to each group of children. Rio says, “There are 8 groups.”

First check Rio’s answer by multiplying: 8 groups with 8 markers in each group. Is that total bigger or smaller than 40?

Then write how many **groups** really get markers.

Answer: _____

7. Jen and Ben each have 36 shells.

Jen makes rows with 4 shells in each row.

Ben makes 4 rows and shares his shells so every row has the same number.

How many shells are in **one of Ben’s rows**?

Answer: _____

8. Explain, then solve.

- (a) A friend keeps mixing up the two jobs a number can have in a division story. Write, in your own words, how you can tell whether a number tells *how many groups* or *how many in each group*. Use the words “in each” somewhere in your answer.
- (b) There are 30 pencils. Each cup holds 6 pencils. How many **cups** are filled? Write that number on the answer line.

Answer: _____